

Field CHA-020

71 acres in Champaign County, Illinois. What the satellite record shows for the 2026 season.

Prepared Oct 6, 2026
Imagery through Oct 2, 2026
Villicus



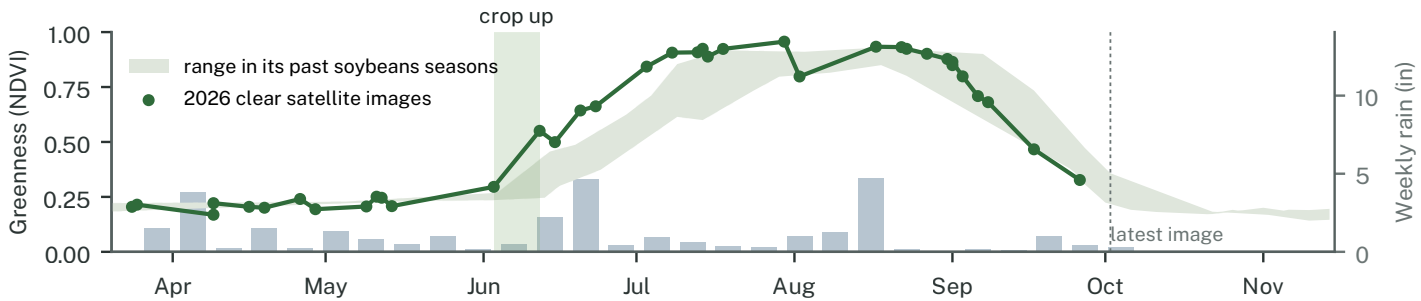
USDA NAIP aerial photo, 2023. Field boundary in yellow.

2026 crop	Soybeans (high confidence)
Crop came up	between Jun 3 and Jun 12, so likely planted May 20 to Jun 5
Harvest	crop had dried down by Sep 26; harvest not yet seen as of Sep 26
After the 2025 harvest	Tilled (fall); residue dropped between Nov 5, 2025 and Nov 17, 2025
Winter 2025-26	No cover crop seen (9 clear winter images, all bare)
Season greenness	1st greenest of its 4 soybeans seasons since 2020; 74th percentile of 1,753 Champaign County soybeans fields

2019 Corn	2020 Soybeans	2021 Corn	2022 Soybeans	2023 Corn	2024 Soybeans	2025 Corn	2026 Soybeans
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Crop by year: USDA Cropland Data Layer 2019-2025; 2026 from our model.

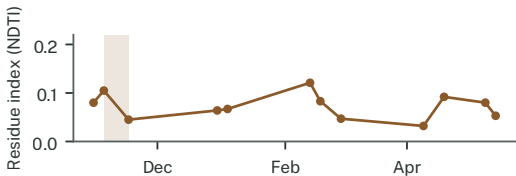
The 2026 season



After the 2025 harvest



Nov 5, 2025, Sentinel-2 (before) Nov 5, 2025, Sentinel-2 (after)



Worth a look

Nothing inside the boundary stood out in the last four seasons: no persistent low spots, no hot spots, no change in land use.

This field is in soybeans for 2026, and the crop was up by Jun 12. Harvest has not shown up in the imagery yet; the latest clear image is from Sep 26. Through the summer it stayed ahead of most soybeans fields in the county (74th percentile on greenness), which tracks crop vigor but is not a yield estimate. It was tilled after last year's harvest (between Nov 5, 2025 and Nov 17, 2025), and nothing inside the boundary stood out as a problem area.

Evidence. Dates above rest on these satellite scenes: Nov 5 2025, tillage (S2C T16TDK orbit 126); Nov 17 2025, tillage (S2A T16TDK orbit 126); Jun 3 2026, crop up (S2C T16TDK orbit 126); Jun 12 2026, crop up (Landsat 9 path/row 023032); Jul 30 2026, peak (Landsat 9 path/row 023032); Sep 17 2026, dry-down (Landsat 8 path/row 022032); Sep 26 2026, dry-down, harvest (S2B T16TDK orbit 126). The chart and winter checks use 81 clear images from Aug 2025 on, all listed in the field record file.

How it was made. Greenness is NDVI and the residue index is NDTI, averaged 10 m inside the boundary (USDA NASS Crop Sequence Boundaries). Crop up is when greenness first passed 0.30; planting is estimated 1-2 weeks earlier. Hot spots use Landsat 8/9 surface temperature. Season greenness tracks crop vigor and is not a yield estimate.